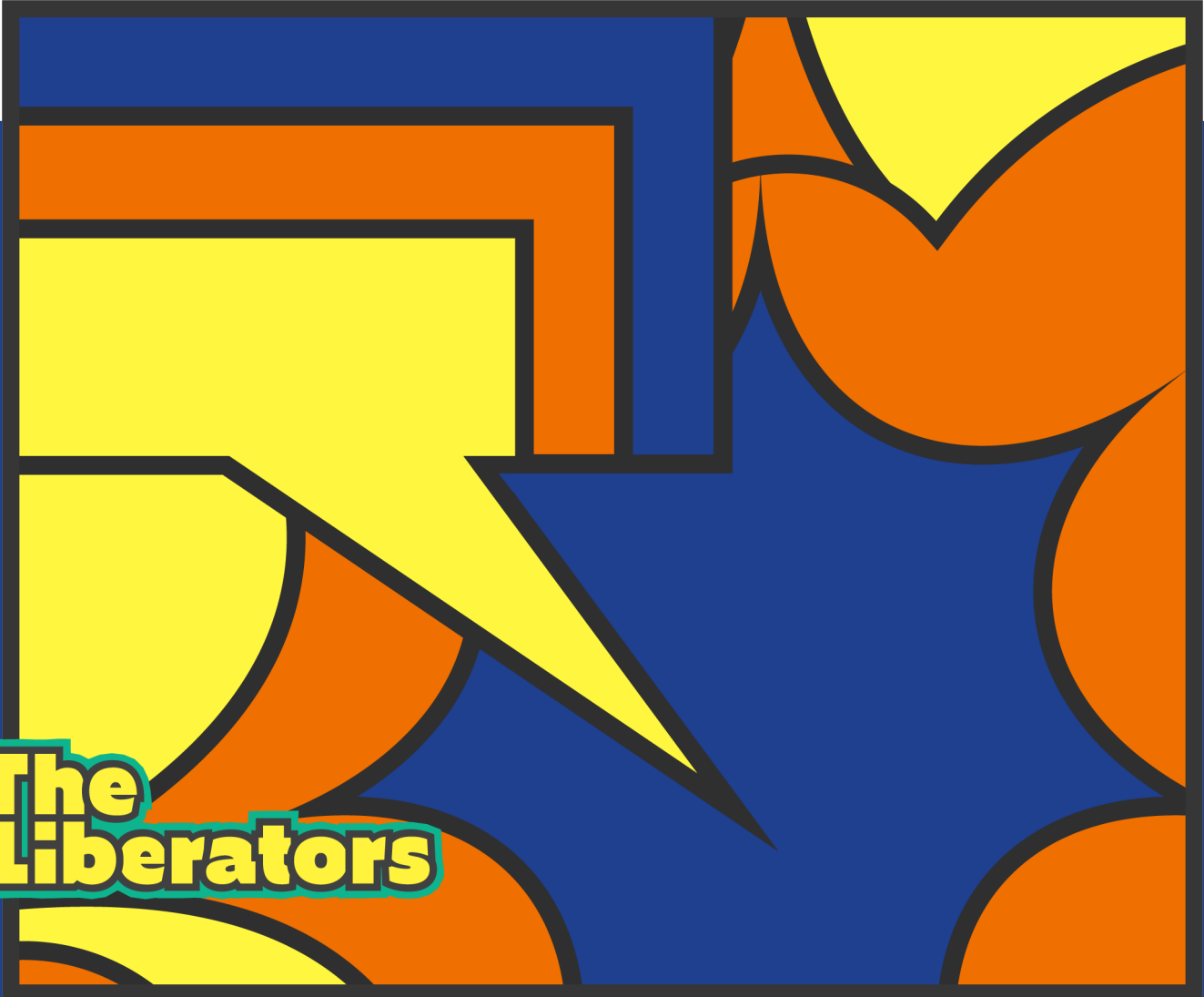


Involve Stakeholders In The Sprint Review With Shift & Share And W3

Use "Shift & Share", "What, So What, Now What" and others to get more valuable feedback out of your Sprint Review with this do-it-yourself workshop



**The
Liberators**

The Purpose Of This Workshop

Hey there!

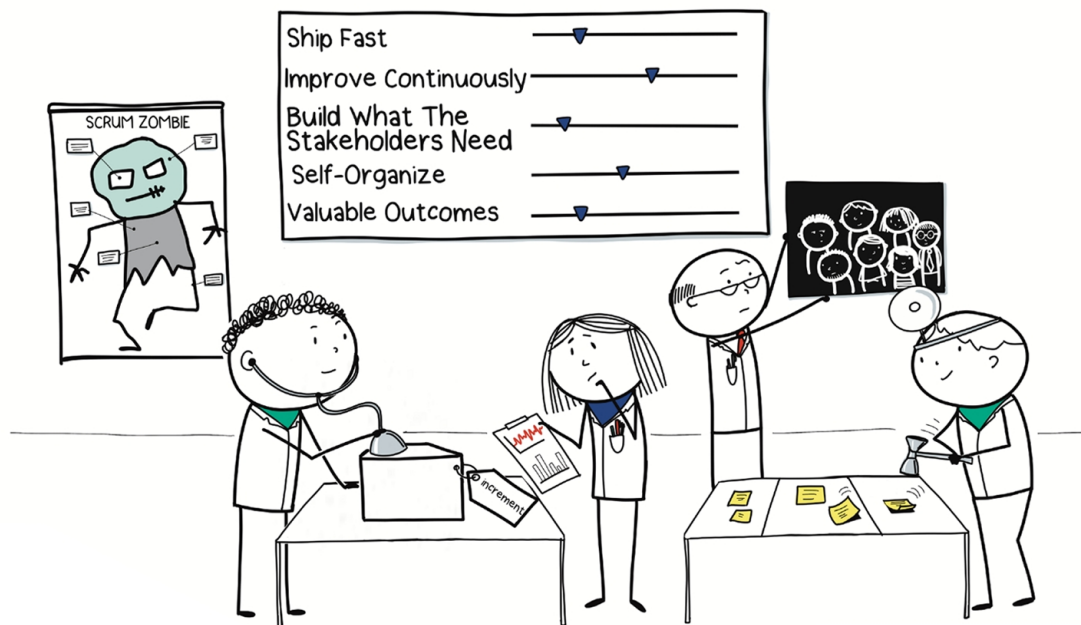
As we wrote in [our book](#), there is little point in Scrum when you don't involve stakeholders. Yet, many Scrum teams struggle to involve their [actual stakeholders](#), and that makes this one of the core symptoms of Zombie Scrum. For some, involving one or two internal stakeholders seems to be enough. For others, stakeholders can only be involved when the entire product is done. But without their feedback, how can you be sure that what you're building is the right thing?

One obvious opportunity to involve your stakeholders is the Sprint Review. In this do-it-yourself workshop, we share a complete and tried-and-tested string of Liberating Structures to get more out of this important Scrum event.

Give it a try and let us know how it went!

Barry & Christiaan

The Liberators



Created by Thea Schukken for the Zombie Scrum Survival Guide
by Christiaan Verwijs, Johannes Schartau & Barry Overeem
zombiescrum.org

Flow

Step 1: Opening	 2 min
Step 2: Set The Stage With "Impromptu Networking"	  15 min
Step 3: Gather Feedback On The Increment With "Shift & Share"	  45 min
Step 4: Debrief The Sprint With "What, So What, Now What"	  40 min
Step 5: Identify Personal Next Steps With "15% Solutions"	  15 min
Step 6: Closing	 3 min
Total duration	 120 min

Difficulty / Effort

Required Skill	☆☆☆☆	The structure takes most of the strain here. Just make sure to pair-up and facilitate together
Impact On Survival	☆☆☆☆	If your Sprint Reviews didn't include stakeholders before, this will cause a landslide in how your team works with them.



The Purpose Of The Sprint Review



The Sprint Review exists to inspect the work that was done in this Sprint and to decide together what next steps make sense based on that inspection. A good Sprint Review is a "lively feedback party" where the Scrum team and its stakeholders look backward *and* forwards. What value has been delivered this Sprint? And what else should the team spend its time on in order to deliver value to its stakeholders?

Compared to the other events that Scrum teams typically go through, the Sprint Review often receives the least attention in how it is facilitated. In most cases, Sprint Reviews are demonstration sessions where the Scrum team merely presents what it has been working on – and nothing more. This wastes a huge learning

opportunity.

Because how much can really be learned from a demonstration, often even without an opportunity for stakeholders to try it out for themselves? It is more likely that stakeholders only get to see the "happy path" where nothing fails and all known issues are conveniently hidden or side-stepped in an effort to wow stakeholders. But this is not transparent. And it doesn't encourage inspection or adaptation.

When Sprint Reviews are inspected in such a "read-only" fashion, it is no surprise that stakeholders rather skip them and wait for the final version – where they can finally try it for themselves.

An Interactive Alternative

We designed the string of Liberating Structures in this experiment with interaction in mind. We've used it many times. Instead of showing the Increment to stakeholders, they get to explore it together with members of the team. Based on the feedback and learnings that emerge from that inspection, a debrief is performed with everyone present. This culminates in an answer to the question: "Now that we know all this, what next steps make sense?".

If this is the first time that stakeholders are invited to your Sprint Review, be prepared for some awkwardness. For example, the language used by the team may be different from what stakeholders recognize. People may be (understandably) nervous. And you may run into errors or misunderstandings. But since that is *exactly* what the Sprint Review is for, it is better to get used to that (and playfully act on it) than to avoid it.



How To Prepare



Group Size

This string of Liberating Structures is feasible from 8 participants (team members and stakeholders) and onward. We've successfully scaled it up to 100 participants without significant issues.

Intended Audience

The invitations and steps for this particular string are aimed at Scrum teams and their stakeholders. This string, as any good Sprint Review does, requires stakeholders to be present. How many stakeholders you want to invite depends on your product and the size of your team. But a ratio of 1 team member to 2 or 3 stakeholders is generally great.

It is important to invite [actual stakeholders](#). These are the people who have an actual stake in your work as a team, either because they invest significant amounts of time and/or money in it. An actual stakeholder is someone who clearly gains something when you deliver good work and loses something when you don't. Everyone else is your audience.

If you're unclear who your stakeholders are, you can create a [Stakeholder Map](#) first. Invite people in the "Promoters"-quadrant first, followed by the "Defenders"-quadrant and a few from the "Latents"-quadrant. If you have space, you can include participants from the "Audience"-quadrant.

Virtual Delivery

Liberating Structures work well virtually. Here too, they allow you to unleash and involve everyone. What is exceptionally important, however, is that you have the right tools. Because Liberating Structures are fundamentally about breaking down large-group interactions into smaller groups, you need tools that allow you to create subchannels or breakout rooms easily. [Zoom](#) is ideal for this, but similar features are available in tools like [Teams](#) and [GotoMeeting](#). We also recommend a virtual whiteboard where you can collect shared insights, like [Mural](#), [Miro](#), or [Google Slides](#). Even [Slack](#) can work.

Material

- With your Scrum team, prepare 3 to 7 stations for the Shift & Share (see what is expected in the description there). If you do this virtually, make sure to set the necessary permissions for screen sharing.
- Prepare a set of "Feedback Cards" where stakeholders can leave feedback during the Shift & Share. You can also use a shared workspace like Mural or Google Slides if you're doing this virtually.
- Create a shared space (on a wall, the floor or virtually) where you can collect the insights from the various rounds.
- Prepare slides or supporting materials for the various rounds and their invitations. Make sure to clearly include the Sprint Goal and the Product Goal – these are the touchstones for all your decisions.



Step 1: Opening

Start by clarifying the purpose of this gathering. While also making sure to announce this upfront in invitations, ask the Product Owner to reiterate the purpose of the Sprint Review as well as the purpose of this Sprint as captured in a Sprint Goal and its relationship to the larger Product Goal.

Because this string very much depends on interaction, we highly recommend that you keep the opening as short as possible. Otherwise, people quickly shift into the "presentation mode" where they sit back to listen.



Step 2: Set The Stage With "Impromptu Networking"

We want the Sprint Review to be a highly interactive and engaging event. And to set the tone from the start, we start with [Impromptu Networking](#). This is an excellent Liberating Structure to get everyone's thinking started and to get a sense of what is happening in the group. In three rounds, people pair up with someone else and take turns to respond to the following invitation:

Invitation

"Based on the Sprint Goal, what questions, expectations, and considerations come to mind for today? What else?"

Steps

1. **1 min** Individually, ask everyone present to individually and silently write down their questions, expectations, and considerations.
2. **4 min** Invite everyone to form pairs and share what they wrote down. If you're doing this virtually, assign people to breakout rooms. Encourage members of the team to pair with stakeholders, and not with another member of the team.
3. **8 min** Repeat the previous round twice more. Invite people into new pairs, and let them share their expectations, questions, and considerations. More are likely to emerge, and people may start noticing patterns in their responses.
4. **2 min** Ask the group to briefly share the patterns that seem most important to today. Which expectations, questions, or considerations appeared the most?

Resources

- The [original article](#) from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Rapidly share novel ideas and make personal connections with 'Impromptu Networking'](#)



Step 3: Gather Feedback On The Increment With "Shift & Share"



Now that everyone has had the opportunity to get their thinking started about what they are looking for in the Sprint Review, we can start the actual inspection. Instead of a presentation or a demo by the Scrum Team, we instead use the Liberating Structure called [Shift & Share](#). In short rounds, the participants rotate across a number of prepared stations that are hosted by members of the Scrum Team. At each station, stakeholders have the opportunity to interact with parts of the Increment.

Steps

- Explain the sequence of steps;
- **1 min** Identify the 3-7 prepared stations by asking their hosts to announce the topic for their station. Each station is hosted by one member of the Scrum Team and focuses on a relevant area of the Increment to be inspected — like a related set of Product Backlog Items — or other relevant topics — like release planning, technical debt, market conditions, or product vision. The hosts remain with their station throughout "Shift & Share", but everyone else rotates across them in short rounds. If you do this virtually, each station has its own break-out room.
- **2 min** Allow the station hosts to set up. If you do this virtually, you can create breakout rooms and already move the station hosts there. Ask the other participants to evenly distribute themselves across the stations, or move them into the breakout rooms if you're doing this virtually.
- **7 min** For their stations, the hosts invite their participants to interact with the Increment and explain or assist where needed. They can share a link, share a keyboard and screen or offer a number of mobile devices to do so — whatever works best for your product. Stakeholders can either share their feedback right away or capture it on physical "Feedback Cards" or a virtual workspace.
- **21 min** After the first round, repeat at most three more times. Ask the participants to rotate clockwise to the next station. The hosts remain with their current station.

Our Findings

- If you're doing this in-person, participants can simply decide which stations are of the most interest to them and their needs. This is harder to facilitate online – although tools like Zoom allow participants to [self-join rooms](#) (starting from version 5.3).
- You can also invite participants to pick the stations that they are most interested in, or are the most relevant to their needs. This may make facilitation a bit more chaotic. At the same time, it can show clear patterns.
- If your Scrum Team rarely interacts with stakeholders, they may be nervous. You can make it a bit easier by allowing pairs to host each station.

Resources

- The original article on [Shift & Share](#) on the Liberating Structures website
- Blog post: Share novel ideas and creative solutions with '[Shift & Share](#)'



Step 4: Debrief The Sprint With "What, So What, Now What"



After inspecting the increment and other relevant topics during Shift & Share, now is a good time to make sense of the insights that emerged from this inspection. Instead of a group conversation, we're structuring this interaction with a Liberating Structure that is tailored for debriefing a shared experience; [What, So What, Now What](#). This structure uses three consecutive rounds of sense-making, each starting with a moment of individual reflection followed by a brief 4-minute conversation in the small groups and a shared conversation of 8 minutes.

Invitation

Round 1: "What have you seen, heard, or observed during the inspection? What facts or patterns stood out the most?"

Round 2: "So, what does this mean to our work together in this and future Sprints? What seems most important when we consider our Product Goal?"

Round 3: "Now, what adaptations to the Product Backlog or our release plan make sense? What needs to be added, removed or re-ordered?";

Steps

Round 1: Observations

1. **1 min** First individually and in silence, ask people to write down their thoughts on the first invitation. What did they see, hear or observe during the inspection? What was their experience of the Increment like?
2. **4 min** Ask everyone to form small groups (2-4 people) to share what they noticed during the Shift & Share. Encourage them to focus on patterns.

3. **8 min** Together, ask each group to share one observation that they feel is most important to their work together. Capture (other) observations on a shared workspace.

Round 2: Conclusions

1. **1 min** First individually and in silence, ask people to write down their thoughts on the second invitation. What does all this mean for their work together in this and future Sprints?
2. **4 min** Ask everyone to form small groups (2–4 people) to share their conclusions on what seems important. Encourage them to notice patterns.
3. **8 min** Together, ask each group to share one conclusion that they feel is most important. Capture (other) conclusions on a shared workspace.

Round 3: Adaptations

1. **1 min** First individually and in silence, ask people to write down their thoughts on the third invitation. Based on the conclusions drawn, what adaptations need to be made?
2. **4 min** Ask everyone to form small groups (2–4 people) to share their suggestions for the adaptations that need to be made. Encourage them to notice patterns.
3. **8 min** Together, ask each group to share one adaptation that they feel is most important. Capture (other) adaptations on a shared workspace.

Our Findings

- In order to avoid the influence of personal biases and office politics, it is helpful to focus Round 1 on data-driven observations. For example, "it was slow" is not an observation but an opinion. To get at the observation, you can ask: "What would someone other than you have to experience for them to say the same thing?". For example: "It takes over 15 seconds to load the page".
- Most of us tend to jump to conclusions without weighing the facts. This means that "What, So What, Now What" is often hard and counter-intuitive the first few times you do it. But if you explain its purpose, and why you do it as part of a Sprint Review, it will become second nature over time.

Resources

- The [original article](#) from the Liberating Structures website
- Blogpost: [Create shared understanding with 'What, So What, Now What'](#)



Step 5: Identify Personal Next Steps With "15% Solutions"

We always like to end on a personal note by asking everyone present – including the stakeholders – how they can contribute to the success of the product. No matter how small, if everyone makes one small change, together this generates large change. The Liberating Structure [15% Solutions](#) is super useful for this.

Invitation

"What is your 15% Solution to help advance our work together on this product? What is something you can do without needing approval from someone else or resources you don't have access to?"

Steps

1. **1 min** Invite everyone to reflect on the outcomes of the Sprint Review and identify what small steps they can personally take to contribute to the success of their work together.
2. **5 min** Invite people into small groups (2–3) where they briefly share their 15% Solutions and give and get help.
3. **5 min** Debrief with the entire group and give people the opportunity to share their 15% Solutions.

Our Findings

- It is tempting for people to complicate their 15% Solutions, which makes it unlikely they'll actually do them. You can encourage people by asking them "What is the thing you're going to do to work on that [original idea]?"
- You can make individual 15% Solutions transparent on your virtual whiteboard. But make sure that this is optional.

Resources

- The original article on [15% Solutions](#) on the Liberating Structures website
- Blog post: Trigger BIG change by starting small with ["15% Solutions"](#)

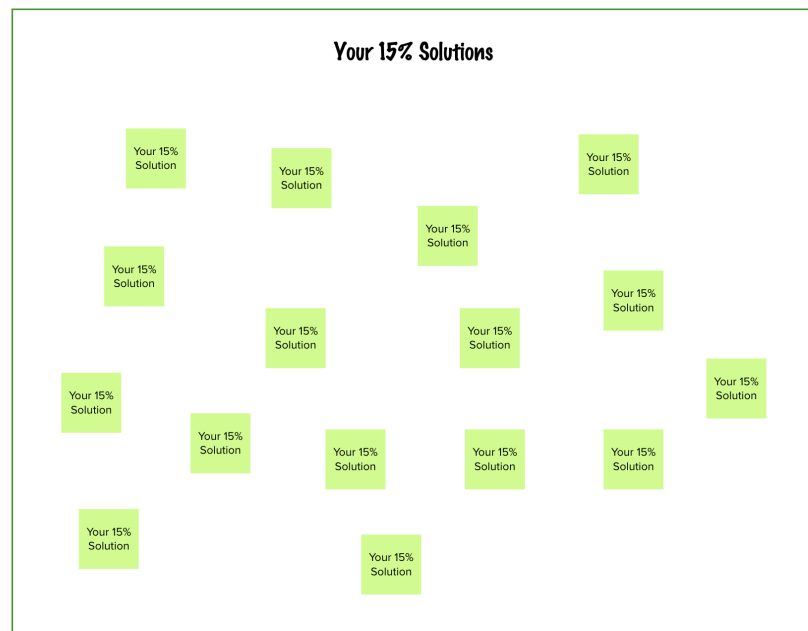
Step 1

Position yourself in the scenario you recognize the most and write down a personal next step.

What is an improvement that you can make, without needing approval from someone else or resources you don't have access to?

Step 2

Pair up and share your 15% Solution while giving and getting help to refine your next step



Step 6: Closing

If you have the time, do a quick debrief with the group. What worked well about this Sprint Review? What can be improved? A simple Liberating Structure for this is [Impromptu Networking](#) ("What did you observe, think or feel while participating in this meetup?"). Draw out some salient patterns from the whole group, but keep it short.

If you've got any questions, comments, or ideas: always feel free to reach out and share them with us.

Let's learn and grow, together!

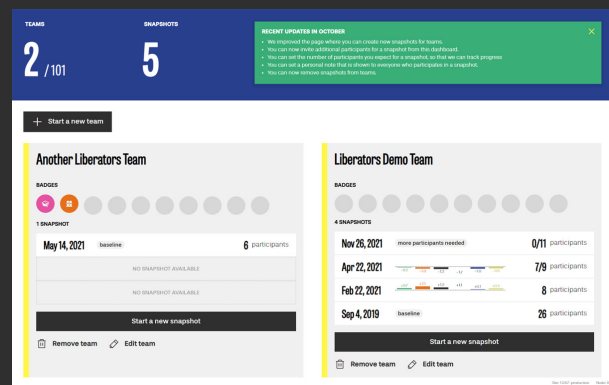
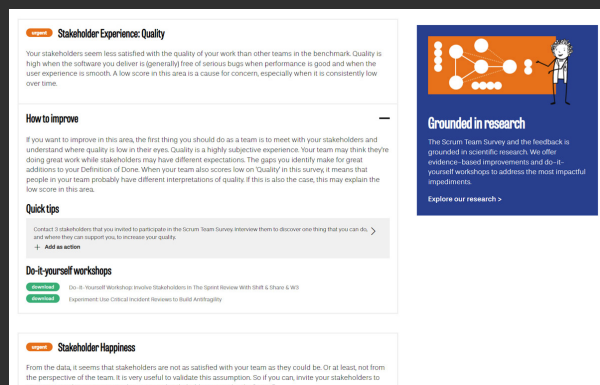
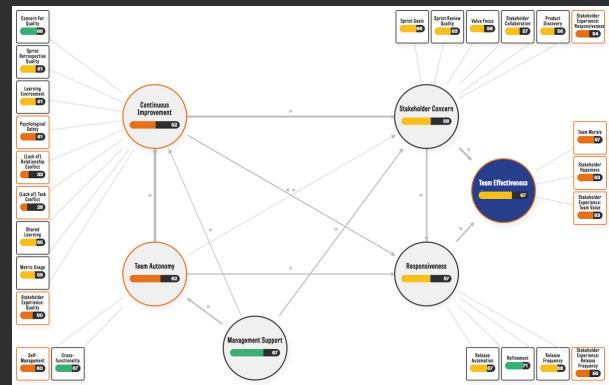
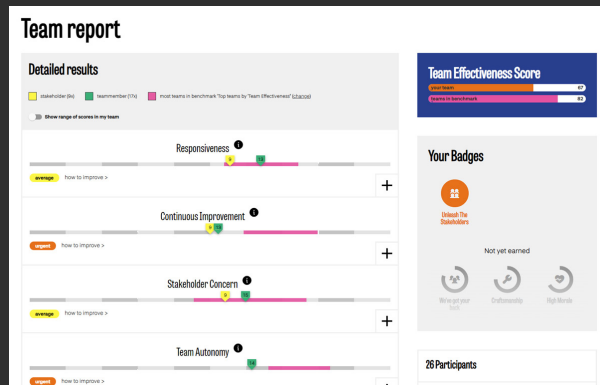
More resources to improve collaboration with stakeholders

- Actual stakeholders? Or just your audience? Read the [blog post](#) or listen to the [podcast episode](#)
- Blog post: [Scrum Mythbusters: The Sprint Review Is A Demo](#)
- Podcast: [The Curious Case of the Missing Stakeholders](#)



Make Your Scrum Team More Effective

Want to make your Scrum team more effective? We created the Scrum Team Survey to help. Invite members and stakeholders to a detailed questionnaire and diagnose the results together. You receive tons of actionable feedback based on your results, including dozens of quick tips and useful do-it-yourself workshops. You can use the Scrum Team Survey for free with your team. No account or e-mail address is required. You can also subscribe for more advanced features.



	Essential	Liberator
Invite team members & stakeholders	unlimited	unlimited
Quick Tips for your team per topic	3	unlimited
Recommendations to your team	5	unlimited
Compare your team against different benchmarks		✓
Analyze the range of scores in your team		✓
Receive our personal guidance on how to get started		✓
See where your team improves over time with Team Trends		✓
Support our academic research to help more teams		✓
Pricing per team per month	€ 0	€ 10

<https://scrumteamsurvey.org>

info@scrumteamsurvey.org

Unleashing Teams All Over The World

We are The Liberators – Barry Overeem and Christiaan Verwijs. Our mission is to create data-driven products to unleash the superpowers of teams all over the world. We do this together with a growing community of patrons.

Awesome content for awesome teams

We unleash teams with our [blogposts](#), our [podcast](#), our [newsletter](#), our [videos](#), and our frequent [meetups](#). While we offer most of this for free, we also have plenty of premium content in [our webshop](#) for you to explore.

Supported by the community

We are super proud that The Liberators is almost entirely funded by the community. If you appreciate our work too, you can already support us for 12 dollars/year by becoming a [patron](#). In return, you gain free access to premium content, we share our work-in-progress and involve you in creating more awesome content.



Thank you for respecting our work!

We work hard to create high-quality content that puts you in a position to unleash your team. We're sure you appreciate that a lot of our time and money goes into this. At the same time, content like this is our main source of income. It's what pays our bills :)

If you purchased this content, we ask only that you treat our work with respect and don't share it with people outside your team. If you stumbled on it elsewhere without paying for it, and it offers you value, would you consider [supporting us too](#)? You can also check [out our other offerings](#).